

price was just too steep. I always clip the coupons for new products, keeping an eye on clearance shelves and carts for just that possibility.

Take advantage of catalina and register reward sales, and roll them. Drugstores like Walgreens, Rite Aid, and CVS may seem like an expensive place to buy your health and beauty items because their prices are so much higher than the discount stores of the world, but not if you watch the ads and take advantage of their sale prices and register reward deals. All of a sudden a \$12.99 razor on sale for \$9.99 with a \$4.00 register reward is more appealing. If you use your \$4.00 coupon on top of that, the expensive razor suddenly becomes a \$1.99 bargain. The caution here is that you must remember to use the register rewards before they expire, usually within a two-week time frame. Also, in regards to the Walgreens register rewards, if you use a register reward for the same product, the registers are programmed not to give you another reward. So save your rewards to purchase something else. Some stores do allow you to “roll” the register rewards, meaning you can use the register rewards on the same item to get another reward. These rules, and even the form of store and register rewards are evolving rapidly as manufacturers try to figure out exactly what works in their favor, so ask a store manager if you are unsure of their policy.

Keep an eye out for clearance shelves. Some of your best deals will be the unadvertised, marked-down specials found on a clearance shelf or a grocery cart full of drastically-reduced merchandise. The code of conduct regarding leaving something for the next shopper totally flies out the window in this instance. If you have twenty coupons for “\$1 off” a certain brand of toothbrush and there are twenty toothbrushes marked down to “\$1